and accounts office would then calculate the emoluments due to each jawan, which was sent to the units in the form of a quarterly statement. Seeing how the 'back-end' works made me appreciate the importance of getting the documentation done in a timely and accurate manner. If ever there was one area that could benefit from automation, this was it, and I was to be part of the automation project nearly three decades later.

The Adjutant of any unit is expected to demonstrate the highest standards of discipline and turnout. My summer uniform had got quite faded in the sun but was not frayed enough to discard. I thought I could get it dyed at a nominal cost rather than getting a new one stitched, since we were hard up for funds. The dyed uniform looked good but was of a darker blackish shade than the regular olive green. I wore it with some trepidation and went to the office as usual, receiving the Commandant on his arrival and interacting with him throughout the office hours. I fully expected him to say something about my uniform and was relieved he hadn't. When it was time to leave, he asked me to accompany him in the staff car, instructing the driver to go to the Officers' Mess. When we reached there, the rest of the officers were waiting at the bar. Drinks are on the Adjutant, he informed everyone, for wearing a dyed uniform. If I had thought he had not noticed, I was sadly mistaken. What a novel and gentle way to chastise someone, also conveying at the same time, a subtle message to the others too. Fortunately, it was only one drink per head, otherwise, my bar tab would have been more than the cost of a new uniform!

In July 1987, the Indo-Sri Lankan Accord was signed, which sought to end the Sri Lankan Civil War between Tamil militant groups such as the Liberation Tigers of Tamil Eelam (LTTE) and Eelam People's Revolutionary Liberation Front (EPRLF) among others, and the Sri Lankan Government. Under the

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